

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

The defaults don't change

Q I have a Pentium 4 2.60c GHz, an Intel D865 GBF motherboard, 256 MB DDR RAM, and an 80 GB hard disk loaded with Windows XP Professional Service Pack 1. I am unable to change the default folder settings. For example, when I change the way the icons in a folder are arranged—by date, size, etc—or if I change from the 'Thumbnail' view to 'Details' view, nothing is saved past a reboot. My user account has administrator rights.

Abhijeet Ghosh

A To get rid of this, open Windows Explorer and go to Tools > Internet Options > Folder Options. Here, look for "Remember each Folder's View Settings" and uncheck it. This done, all your settings will be in place the next time you reboot your system.

Of stubborn shutdowns and errors...

Q I have an Athlon XP 2000 processor running Windows XP. I have three problems:

■ Windows shuts down from all other user accounts except from the one I created.

■ Secondly, whenever I start Norton System Works, or run 'msconfig', it automatically shuts down after few seconds—this doesn't happen with other accounts.

■ Lastly, whenever I log on, I get a message "You or a program has requested uncanny.org, which connection do you want to use" with options to connect to the Internet. This message reappears even if I hit Cancel. What do I do?

Rahul

A Your user account seems to be corrupted. you will have to delete it and create it anew. Save your data before you do so. You will find detailed instructions at <http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?kbid=811151>, which will guide you through the process of saving your data.

As for your last problem, it's a case of spyware infection. Download and install SpyBot (www.safer-networking.org) and AdAware (<http://www.lavasoftusa.com/software/adaware/>)—both free spyware-scanning tools. Run them to remove any installed spyware, and prevent such problems in the near future.

Dial modem dial

Q Here's my system's configuration: A Pentium 4 1.8 GHz on a Gigabyte motherboard, 128 MB RAM, a 40 GB hard disk, and a 56 Kbps D-Link internal modem, running Windows 98 and Windows XP. I hear a ringing sound on my speaker as I try to dial-up in Windows 98, but not from my modem. With Windows XP, I hear the ringing sound from the modem itself. How do I rectify this problem? Also, does my Pentium 4 1.8 GHz processor have only 256 KB of L2 cache memory?

S Riyaz

A You haven't enabled the modem speaker volume in Windows 98. Go to Start > Control Panel > Phone And Modem Options, click on your modem, and then on Properties. Next, click on 'Advanced' and then enable the speaker volume settings for the modem and set it to high.

Also, internal modems, especially the SM56 PCI cards, have a tray application that plays sounds using DirectX. This is their way of telling you about their activity, so it's best to leave it running.

Earlier batches of the Pentium 4 processors, based on the Northwood cores, only had 256 KB of L2 cache. Processors based on the Northwood A core, which came in later, have 512 KB of L2 cache.

Service. What Service?

Q I have Windows XP Professional installed, without Service Pack 1A. I tried installing through Windows Updates, but every time I did, either through Windows Updates or using the Service Pack CDs, it shows "Service Pack 1 Set Up Cancelled". Why does it fail?

Secondly, I have a Pentium III 500, 128 MB RAM and a 40 GB hard disk, on a 440ZX motherboard. The motherboard doesn't detect the hard disk in the BIOS setup. Only 32 GB of the total disk capacity is shown. How do I get it to recognise the remaining disk space?

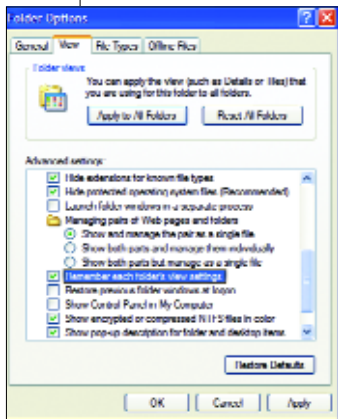
Also, my PS/2 port is not functional. Can I use an optical PS/2 mouse with a PS/2-to-serial port converter?

Jayant

A If you purchased an original Windows XP CD, please get in touch with Microsoft's customer support to solve the problem. If you have installed a pirated version of Windows XP, no Service Packs will install.

You have a very old BIOS version—the 440ZX chipset is over five years old. You'll need to upgrade it to use hard disks larger than 32 GB. Download the latest version from the board manufacturer's Web site, and follow the instructions posted there to flash your BIOS. Remember, this can render your motherboard unusable, if it's not done right.

And lastly, yes, you can connect your PS/2 mouse to a serial port using a PS/2-to-serial converter.



Uncheck this option to get consistent folder views



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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!